

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Analyst Playbook

Advanced Analytics & Power BI workflows for Insights Analysts

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How This Document Fits

This is a **Operate** guide. It walks Insights Analysts through creating Copilot analytics queries, connecting Power BI templates, and publishing reports to leaders. It does **not** cover initial admin configuration — see the Admin Setup Guide for that.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate (you are here)	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

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1. Prerequisites

Before you can create Copilot analytics queries and connect Power BI templates, the following must be in place:

Prerequisite	Details
Viva Insights licence	Minimum 50 licences in the tenant for Advanced Analytics. Included with M365 Copilot licences
Insights Analyst role	Must be assigned to your account by an Insights Admin or Global Admin via the Microsoft 365 a
Partition access	An Insights Admin must grant you access to the relevant partition(s). Without partition access, y
Org data uploaded	Organisational data (department, agency, location, etc.) must be uploaded for segmentation and
Power BI Desktop	June 2022 or later. Required to open <code>.pbix</code> template files downloaded from Viva Insights.

Insights Admin ≠ Insights Analyst

These are **different roles** with different permissions. The **Insights Admin** configures the system (uploads org data, creates partitions, manages access). The **Insights Analyst** runs queries and builds reports. You need the **Analyst** role to follow this playbook. If you have the Admin role but not the Analyst role, ask your Global Admin to assign both.

Data Requirements

Timing matters. Plan your data collection window *before* Copilot rolls out if you need before/after analysis:

Data Requirement	Minimum	Notes
Org data upload	Required	Enables segmentation by department, agency, location, job function, and other at
Pre-adoption baseline	4 weeks	Needed for before/after comparison in the Copilot Impact template. Must be colle
Post-adoption data	4 weeks	Minimum period after Copilot rollout for meaningful usage patterns to emerge.

Plan Ahead for Before/After Analysis

If Copilot has already been rolled out across your tenant, **before/after comparison may not be possible**. The Impact template requires pre-adoption collaboration data as a baseline. Plan your analytics strategy *before* licence assignment to ensure you capture baseline data.

2. Available Copilot PBI Templates

Microsoft provides several Power BI templates purpose-built for Copilot analytics. Each template creates a pre-built query with predefined metrics and a corresponding `.pbit` file for Power BI Desktop.

Template	Purpose	Key Metrics
M365 Copilot Impact	Primary ROI and productivity analysis	Assisted hours, assisted v
M365 Copilot Adoption	Usage trends and feature adoption depth	Active users over time, per
Copilot Headlines (preview)	Auto-scanned executive insights	Power users, adoption ben
Copilot Business Impact	Correlate Copilot usage with business outcomes	Business KPI correlation (r
Copilot Studio Agents	Agent usage and impact analysis	Agent session outcomes, c
Copilot Employee Experience (Glint)	Correlate Copilot usage with employee sentiment	Usage patterns mapped to

Where to Find These Templates

The official Copilot templates are **not distributed as standalone download links**. You access them **in-product**: in the Viva Insights analyst experience (analysis.insights.viva.office.com) select **Create analysis**, then pick a template from the **Copilot** section and select **Set up analysis**. The `.pbit` file is generated from the **query results page** after the query runs (see Section 4).

For the full catalogue and per-report setup guides, see the Microsoft Learn template catalogue. Not all templates may be visible in your tenant — availability depends on your licence entitlements, feature rollout status, and whether prerequisites (e.g., Glint licence, business outcome data upload) are met.

3. Step-by-Step: Create a Report

This walkthrough uses the **M365 Copilot Impact** template as the example, but the process is similar for all templates.

Step 1 — Sign In to the Analyst Experience

Navigate to **analysis.insights.viva.office.com** and sign in with your organisational account that has the Insights Analyst role.

Step 2 — Start a New Analysis

Select **Create analysis** → **Templates** → **Copilot** → choose the desired template (e.g., *M365 Copilot Impact*) → **Set up analysis**.

Step 3 — Configure Query Settings

Set the following:

- **Query name** — use a descriptive name (e.g., “Copilot Impact Q1 2026 — All Agencies”)
- **Time period** — select the analysis window (up to 13 months of historical data)
- **Auto-refresh** — enable if you want the query to re-run automatically on a schedule
- **Description** — optional but recommended for team documentation

Step 4 — Review Predefined Metrics

The template pre-selects the required metrics (shown as grey tags — these cannot be removed). You can optionally add extra metrics to include in the query output.

Step 5 — Set Employee Filters

Apply filters to scope the query population:

- **“Is Active”** — always recommended to exclude departed employees
- **Org attributes** — filter by department, agency, location, or any uploaded org data attribute as needed

Step 6 — Add Organisational Attributes

Select up to **20 organisational attributes** to include in the query output. These attributes become available as group-by and filter dimensions in Power BI. Include any attribute you may want to slice by later — you cannot add them after the query runs.

Step 7 — Run the Query

Select **Run**. Depending on population size and time window, the query may take minutes to hours to complete. You will receive a notification when results are ready.

Data Quality Warnings

During query setup, the system may flag data quality issues:

- **Yellow warning** — low quality or partial coverage for an attribute. The query will still run.
- **Red warning** — missing attribute entirely. The query will run but that attribute will not be usable for segmentation.

Address data quality issues by working with your Insights Admin to update the org data upload.

4. Connect Power BI

Once your query completes, connect it to the Power BI template:

Step 1 — Download the Template

From the query results page in Viva Insights, download the `.pbit` template file.

Step 2 — Open in Power BI Desktop

Open the downloaded `.pbit` file in Power BI Desktop. When prompted, paste:

- **Partition ID** — found in the Viva Insights analyst experience
- **Query ID** — found on the query results page

Step 3 — Set Minimum Group Size

Set the minimum group size for privacy thresholds (e.g., 10). Groups smaller than this threshold will be suppressed in the report. Click **Load**.

Step 4 — Sign In

When prompted for credentials, select **Organisational account** and sign in with the same account used to run the query.

Step 5 — Configure Report Settings

After data loads, configure the report settings on the Settings page:

- **Time period** — define the reporting window within the query's date range
- **Group-by attribute** — select the primary organisational attribute for segmentation (e.g., Department, Agency)
- **Active user definition** — set the threshold for what constitutes an "active" Copilot user
- **Language** — set report language

Explore the Report Pages

The Copilot Impact template includes several pre-built pages:

- **Summary** — high-level overview of Copilot impact across the organisation
- **Before vs After** — compares collaboration patterns before and after Copilot adoption
- **Copilot vs Non-Copilot** — compares metrics between users with and without Copilot licences
- **Two-Group Comparison** — compare two organisational segments side by side
- **Research Insights** — deeper statistical analysis and trend exploration

5. Programmatic Reporting Options

Choose the reporting path based on the question, population, privacy model, and automation requirement. These options are not interchangeable: a dashboard export is not an Advanced query, Microsoft Graph does not cover unlicensed Copilot Chat usage, and audit events are not equivalent to adoption metrics.

Option	Best for
Copilot Dashboard export (preview)	Offline adoption analysis, custom communications, and short- or medium-
Advanced Reporting query	Custom metrics, filters, org attributes, cohort analysis, and Power BI template
Microsoft Graph Copilot report API (v1.0)	Scheduled licensed-user usage reporting and integration into governed da
Admin report and Purview audit sources	Unlicensed Copilot Chat reporting, compliance investigation, and event-level

Dashboard export: fixed user-level dataset

The Copilot Dashboard's **Export data** feature is public preview. Week-level export provides the last **six months**, refreshes weekly, and can be up to six days old. Day-level export provides the last **28 days**, refreshes daily, and can be up to three days old. Both remove personal identifiers and replace them with anonymized IDs; neither can be customized. The feature currently excludes Copilot assisted hours.

Day-level exports lag licence changes by two days

Copilot Analytics takes up to **seven days** to process a licence assignment. Day-level export is the exception and surfaces changes sooner — but a day-level export run **within two days** of a Copilot licence assignment or removal will **not** reflect that change. Day-level exports run after the two-day window reflect it accurately. Already-generated files are **not updated automatically** — a corrected figure requires a fresh export.

Do not use an export taken immediately after a licence movement to validate that movement. Reconcile licence counts against the Microsoft 365 admin center, or re-run the export after the two-day window and record which export generation the figures came from.

Source: Export Copilot metrics from the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard (Last updated 15 July 2026), Prerequisites section, and Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 18 August 2026), Feature availability section.

Global access carries a wider data-handling responsibility

Eligible exporters include senior leaders with global access, users manually assigned global access, delegates of globally scoped users, Insights Analysts with global access, and Microsoft 365 Global Administrators. Managers and their delegates with team-level views cannot export. Treat every download as a governed user-level dataset even though direct identifiers are removed.

Advanced queries: customizable and partition-scoped

Use Advanced Reporting when you need selected metrics, employee filters, organizational attributes, a defined privacy threshold, or a reusable Power BI model. Microsoft documents more than 100 Copilot metrics. Unlike the fixed Dashboard export, the available query population is constrained by the analyst's assigned partition. For Copilot metrics, design within the documented **13-month** history and account for data freshness.

Microsoft Graph v1.0: licensed users only

The current Copilot report root exposes both a user-count summary and user detail in `v1.0` :

```
GET https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/copilot/reports/getMicrosoft365CopilotUserCountSummary(period='D30')
GET https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/copilot/reports/getMicrosoft365CopilotUsageUserDetail(period='D30')?$format=application/json
```

API property	Current requirement
Least-privileged delegated or application permission	<code>Reports.Read.All</code>
Report shapes	<code>getMicrosoft365CopilotUserCountSummary</code> for aggregate user
Supported period values	<code>D7</code> , <code>D30</code> , <code>D90</code> , <code>D180</code> , <code>ALL</code>
<code>ALL</code> meaning	Returns report periods for 7, 30, 90, and 180 days; it is not an unli
Population	Users with a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence only
Prompt detail	Per-user Copilot prompt counts across tenants are not supporte
National clouds	Available in Global service; not available in US Government L4, US
Production version	Use <code>v1.0</code> ; Microsoft states that <code>/beta</code> APIs are subject to cha

Unlicensed Copilot Chat: admin report or audit

Unlicensed Copilot Chat usage is **not returned** by the Graph Copilot reports API. Use the Microsoft 365 admin center **Copilot Chat Usage** report for the current operational report. For programmatic event extraction, Microsoft documents **Microsoft Purview Audit**, `Search-UnifiedAuditLog` in PowerShell, and the **Office 365 Management Activity API**.

Audit is an alternative source, not a metric-compatible substitute

Audit data supports compliance and event analysis. Do not present event counts as if they were the admin report's active-user or adoption measures. Define event types, deduplication, retention, permissions, latency, identity handling, and aggregation before publishing a trend.

Architecture decision

1. Use the **Dashboard export** for a governed, fixed adoption dataset that includes current unlicensed Chat and usage-intensity measures.
2. Use **Advanced queries** when partition scope, custom metrics, filters, organizational attributes, or Power BI templates are required.
3. Use **Graph v1.0** for scheduled licensed-user usage integrations with `Reports.Read.All`.
4. Use the **admin report** for current unlicensed Chat reporting; use **Purview/Management Activity** only when event-level programmatic extraction is the actual requirement.
5. Persist only the minimum required data, apply access and retention controls, record source/period/refresh time, and validate totals against the source experience.

6. Business Impact and Value Interpretation

6.1 Copilot Business Impact setup

The **Copilot Business Impact** report relates Copilot usage patterns to business outcomes supplied by your organization. It does not create the outcome data and does not establish that Copilot caused an observed difference.

Prerequisite	Current requirement
Roles and software	Insights Analyst role; Power BI Desktop June 2022 or newer
Measured population	Employees in scope have both Viva Insights and Microsoft 365 Copilot licences
Comparison size	Microsoft recommends at least 65 Copilot and 65 non-Copilot users
Outcome data	Upload through a manual CSV or Azure blob import; include one row per user for every month in
Time alignment	Outcome months must align with the query; Copilot metrics have up to 13 months of history and
Query design	Select up to five business outcome metrics; fixed monthly grouping; retain the predefined Is Act

1. Agree the outcome owner, unit, direction of favorable performance, population, baseline period, and expected lag before loading data.
2. Upload business outcome data through the Insights Administrator's approved CSV or Azure path and verify one user-month row for each queried month.
3. In **Create analysis**, select **Copilot Business Impact report** and **Set up analysis**.
4. Choose a time period that overlaps complete outcome data, then select up to five outcome metrics.
5. Keep **Is Active**, add only defensible filters and attributes, review data-quality warnings, and run the query.
6. In report settings, document the favorable-outcome threshold and any changes to low, medium, and high Copilot usage categories.
7. Review results with the outcome owner and a statistical or evaluation specialist before publishing a business claim.

Relationship is not causation

Microsoft states that group differences in this report have not been evaluated for statistical significance and that Copilot is unlikely to be the only variable involved. Role mix, prior performance, self-selection, rollout targeting, seasonality, business conditions, and the time needed for an outcome to change can all affect the result. Describe findings as **associations** or **observed differences**, publish sample sizes and definitions, and do not claim ROI or causal impact without an appropriate evaluation design.

6.2 Agent Assisted Hours and Value

Copilot assisted hours and Agent Assisted Hours are modeled estimates. They use different activity inputs and assumptions; neither is a timesheet, realized saving, budget reduction, or proof of business value.

Measure	Model and assumptions
Microsoft 365 Copilot assisted hours/value	Actions are multiplied by research-derived time-savings factors. Value r
Maker-led Agent Assisted Impact	Inputs are supplied from Copilot Studio and displayed in Viva Insights; m
Inferred conversational-agent AAH	(knowledge-source references + weighted sessions without knowl
Inferred autonomous-agent AAH	Combines time estimated for knowledge retrieval, actions, and successf
Agent Assisted Value	Agent Assisted Hours multiplied by an average hourly rate, US\$72 by def

Before publishing value, pair the estimate with observed outcomes: volume, resolution, escalation, abandonment, satisfaction, quality, cycle time, and an organization-owned business KPI. A higher modeled value alongside poor resolution or satisfaction is a prompt to inspect assumptions and agent design, not a success conclusion.

Dated Microsoft Learn sources

Source	Last updated	Used for
Export Copilot metrics from the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard	15 July 2026	Preview export prerequisites, d
Microsoft 365 Copilot reports for IT admins	16 September 2025	Admin center, Viva Insights, Pur
copilotReportRoot: getMicrosoft365CopilotUsageUserDetail	30 July 2026	v1.0 request, permissions, perio
copilotReportRoot: getMicrosoft365CopilotUserCountSummary	15 July 2026	v1.0 aggregate user-count endp
Copilot Business Impact report	5 August 2026	Outcome data, cohort recomm
Microsoft 365 Copilot impact report	5 August 2026	13-month history, freshness, as
Copilot Studio agents report	23 June 2026	Maker-led and inferred Agent A

7. Publish & Share Reports

Once your report is built (Sections 1–4), you have **two delivery surfaces** for getting it in front of leaders. They are not interchangeable — they differ in where recipients view the report, what access it grants them, and how well they respect agency boundaries. Pick the surface that matches your distribution model, then follow the matching sub-section below.

	7.1 Publish via Viva Insights	7.2 Share via Power BI
Where recipients view	Viva Insights web app → Reports tab	Power BI
Best for	Fast, native distribution to leaders who already have Copilot Dashboard access	Controlled distribution to agency heads
Viewer licence	Viva Insights service plan (included with Copilot)	Power BI Pro or Premium
Respects agency isolation	⚠ Risk — see the 5.1 warning	✅ Yes

Implementing the Isolation model? Use 7.2, not 7.1

If you are delivering reports under the Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture, distribute to agency heads via **Power BI (Section 7.2)**. **Do not** use Viva Insights Publish (7.1) to reach agency leaders: enabling a manager so they can receive a published report grants them **Copilot Dashboard access, including the “Your company” scope that shows aggregated data across all agencies** — which breaks isolation. Reserve 7.1 for Central IT analysts who already have tenant-wide dashboard access. See the Isolation playbook, Phase 4b.

7.1 Publish via Viva Insights

You can share query results with business leaders directly from Viva Insights using the **Publish** feature. This is the fastest route for leaders who already have Copilot Dashboard access.

Step 1 — Select Publish

In the Viva Insights analyst experience, navigate to your completed query and select **Publish**.

Step 2 — Set Report Metadata

Enter:

- **Title** — the report title that recipients will see
- **Publisher name** — your name or team name

- **Description** — brief summary of what the report covers

Step 3 — Choose Scope

Select one of:

- **Unfiltered original** — publishes the full dataset. All recipients see the same data.
- **Filter by manager hierarchy** — each recipient sees only data for their reporting line.

Step 4 — Set Expiry Date

Set when the published report expires. Maximum is **365 days** from publication.

Step 5 — Publish

Confirm and publish. Recipients receive an email notification with a link to view the report.

No Auto-Notification Before Expiry

Published reports expire silently — there is **no automatic notification** sent before a report expires. Set a calendar reminder to re-publish before the expiry date to avoid gaps in leader access.

Multi-Agency Tenants: Manager Hierarchy Risk

Enabling a manager so they can receive a published report also grants them **Copilot Dashboard access** — including the **“Your company” scope, which shows aggregated data across all agencies**, not just their own reporting line. In a multi-agency tenant this breaks agency isolation. For agency-head delivery, use Power BI sharing (Section 7.2) instead, and reserve Viva Insights Publish for Central IT who already have tenant-wide dashboard access. See the Multi-Agency Setup Guide and the Isolation playbook (Phase 4b).

7.2 Share via Power BI

Unlike Publish via Viva Insights (Section 7.1), which distributes results *natively* inside Viva Insights, this method uses **Power BI’s own sharing**. It is the preferred method for multi-agency tenants because it delivers a report to named people **without** granting them any Copilot Dashboard access — whereas 7.1’s “Filter by manager hierarchy” option can (see its warning).

New to Power BI? Start Here

This section assumes an Insights Analyst has already **built the report** in Sections 1–4 (run a query, connect the template, save the file). **If you are an admin handling only distribution**, you can start at Step 1 below with a report file the analyst hands you.

Three Power BI terms used in this section:

- **.pbix** — the finished report file. When the analyst loads data into the **.pbix** template (Section 4) and saves it, it becomes a **.pbix**. That is the file you publish.
- **Workspace** — a shared container in the Power BI service that holds reports and controls who can see them.
- **Dataset** — the data behind a report; publishing a **.pbix** uploads the report and its dataset together.

Step 1 — Publish the .pbix to the Power BI Service

In Power BI Desktop, select **Publish** and choose a destination **workspace** (not “My workspace”, which can’t be shared with others). The report and its dataset upload to app.powerbi.com.

Step 2 — Use a Dedicated Workspace per Audience

Create one workspace per agency or audience (e.g., **Agency A – Copilot Analytics**). Keeping each agency’s reports in a separate workspace is the cleanest way to control who sees what. Store all **.pbix** files here rather than on individual machines so reporting survives staff changes.

Step 3 — Assign Stakeholders via Workspace Roles

In app.powerbi.com, open the workspace → select **Manage access** → **Add people or groups**, then assign a workspace role from the table below. Prefer adding an **Entra security group** over individuals, so access is managed centrally and consistently with your other governance controls.

Role	Can do	Assign to
Viewer	View and interact with reports only	Most stakeholders (agency leaders)
Contributor	Create/edit content; can’t manage access	Co–analysts who build reports
Member	Edit content and add others (below Admin)	Trusted leads who help run the workspace
Admin	Full control, including deleting the workspace	The owning analyst / Central IT

Cleaner Distribution for Wide Audiences

For a large, read-only audience, publish the workspace as a **Power BI app** — a packaged, read-only view of selected reports (not a desktop or mobile application). Give the audience access to the app rather than the workspace, so recipients get a curated view without seeing the underlying workspace contents.

Step 4 — Confirm Viewer Licensing

Power BI sharing is licensed **separately** from Viva Insights and Copilot:

- Each viewer needs a **Power BI Pro** or **Premium Per User (PPU)** licence; *or*
- if the workspace sits on a **Power BI Premium capacity (P or F SKU)**, viewers with a free Power BI licence can view the reports — removing per-viewer costs. Confirm with your licensing owner.

Multi-Agency: Keep Boundaries Intact

Grant each agency workspace's **Viewer** role only to that agency's leaders — via an agency-scoped Entra group. If multiple agencies must share one workspace, add Row-Level Security (RLS) as a secondary control. The full agency-isolation delivery procedure (including the Publish Reports pitfall) is in the Isolation Architecture playbook, Phase 4b.

8. Ongoing Maintenance

Keep your Copilot analytics current with these recurring tasks:

- **Refresh org data monthly** — work with your Insights Admin to ensure organisational data (new hires, transfers, departures) stays up to date. Stale org data leads to inaccurate segmentation.
- **Re-run queries periodically** — either enable auto-refresh during query setup or manually re-run queries on a monthly or quarterly cadence to capture current trends.
- **Update PBI reports** — when Microsoft releases updated template versions, download the new `.pbit` and reconnect to benefit from new metrics and visualisations.
- **Share via Publish Reports or Power BI workspaces** — for ongoing distribution, either re-publish through Viva Insights or save `.pbix` files to a shared Power BI workspace (see Section 7.2 for the step-by-step).

9. Analyst Departure — Transfer Guide

When an Insights Analyst leaves the organisation or changes roles, follow this checklist to ensure continuity:

Item	What Happens
Completed query results	Persist in Viva Insights — a new analyst with partition access can view them
Scheduled / recurring queries	May stop running when the account is disabled or deleted
Published reports	Remain accessible until their expiry date, but cannot be renewed by a different analyst
Power BI files (.pbix)	Stored locally on the analyst’s machine — lost if not transferred
Partition access	Role assignment is per-user — does not transfer automatically

Redundancy Is Essential

Always have **at least two analysts** with partition access. Store all `.pbix` files in a shared Power BI workspace rather than on individual machines. This prevents data loss and reporting gaps during transitions.

10. What to Read Next

Document	When to Read
Dashboard & Reports Guide	You want to understand the Copilot Dashboard metrics and pages that leaders
Consumption Dashboard Operations	You need to monitor Copilot Credits, usage intensity, and spending-policy limit
Tools & Reporting Options	You need a reporting-path comparison or reusable validation utility
Data Onboarding Guide	You need to prepare or update the organisational data upload
Attribute Reference	You need the full list of org data attributes and their mapping rules
Troubleshooting Guide	Something isn't working — query failures, missing data, or access issues

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